

Static Files in Development Environment – {% static %} tag

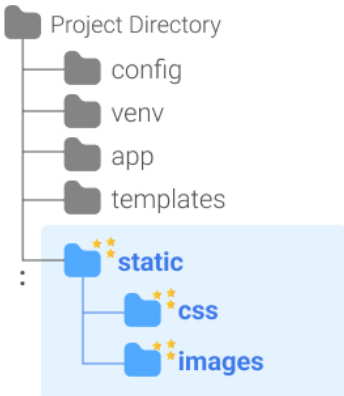
 **template file**

```
{% load static %}

<link rel='stylesheet' href="{% static 'css/xxx.css' %}">


```

Typical directory structure



 **settings.py**

Defines static directory location

```
STATICFILES_DIRS = [ BASE_DIR / 'static' ]
```

```
{% load static %}
```

- Add this tag in the beginning of each template file

```
{% static 'file path' %}
```

- Define the location of static files
- The **file path** should be written as a relative path from the static directory

Static files are files that don't change dynamically, such as image, video, CSS, and JavaScript files. These files are typically saved in a particular location for efficient resource handling.

In the production environment, handling static files is slightly complicated. This lesson will cover static file handling in the development environment.

Static directory location

In Django, the *static* directory is usually placed directly under the project directory with sub-directories such as *css*, *images* or *js*. The *static* directory path should be registered in the *settings.py* file so that Django can handle static files properly. The example below